

1,700

IS THE NUMBER OF AICTE ACCREDITED MANAGEMENT SCHOOLS IN THE COUNTRY. THE TOTAL BUSINESS EDUCATION MARKET IS PEGGED AT Rs 3,000 CRORE.

2,60,000

CANDIDATES TOOK THE CAT EXAM IN 2008, OF WHICH 54,000 WERE WOMEN. IN 2003, THERE WERE LESS THAN A LAKH CAT ASPIRANTS.

90%

STUDENTS AT IIMS ARE ENGINEERS WHILE ALMOST 50 PER CENT OF THOSE AT LIBA-CHENNAI ARE NON-ENGINEERS, FROM STREAMS LIKE HOSPITALITY, MEDIA AND SCIENCE.

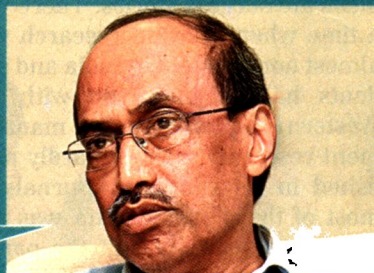


B-SCHOOLS ARE NOW ENCOURAGING STUDENTS FROM ALL STREAMS TO APPLY

Latest research shows that more than two-fifths of MBA aspirants worldwide are women. In India, 54,000 women sat for the CAT in 2008 but at most B-schools, the number of women students is less than 20 per cent. Ross Geraghty, managing editor, TopMBA.com, says, "I expect this trend to change over the next five to 10 years, but I don't think it will reach 40 per cent for many years." But there is a silver lining. The B-schools are doing their bit to promote management as a discipline among women. For instance, IIM-Bangalore (IIM-B) has a unique management programme for creating women entrepreneurs and this initiative has resulted in several start-ups.

Apart from diversity in the classroom, entrepreneurship is being aggressively promoted at most of the B-schools. Last year's global recession turned out to be the best time for start-ups and prompted many graduates to sit out of the placement

process. The N.S. Raghavan Centre for Entrepreneurial Studies (NSRCEL) at the IIM-B which was set up in March 2002 nurtures future leaders and is also an incubation cell for start-ups. In the cell, they select a novel idea, refine it and mentor the student to convert one's business idea into a reality. Similarly, the ISB has the Wadhvani Centre for Entrepreneurship Development which works towards creating a vast body of knowledge through intensive research to guide and facilitate a start-up. Everything from the legal aspect to the funding is covered here. "The interest among students is rising tremendously. Two years ago, when we started the Entrepreneurship and Venture Capital Club, less than 100 students had joined. Today we have upward of 300. This year, more than 100 students have applied to stay out of the placement process in order to launch their own business plan," says Krishna Tanuku, executive director, Wadhvani



"We routinely revise the curriculum to bring in newer elements based on theoretical developments as well as emerging needs of practice."

SAMIR K. BARUA, *Director, IIM-A*



"We encourage students to either attend an exchange programme or intern with foreign firms to absorb their business models and ethics."

GANESH N. PRABHU, *Professor, IIM-B*